

Independent Power Producers: Sparks & Quarks

CEG Inks 20-Year PPA With AMZN; FERC Filing Introduces Uncertainty Around RBP Timeline; IPPs Lead

- **Sentiment check: CEG inks 20-year PPA with AMZN; FERC RBP auction delay top of mind.** After market close, CEG [announced](#) a 20-year PPA with AMZN for 690MW at the Calvert Cliffs Clean Energy Center, including a 190MW uprate entering service between 2030-2032. We see the deal as a notable win, catching the market by surprise and demonstrating a contracting path forward despite regulatory uncertainty. IPPs sold off Wednesday after FERC's Tuesday night filing, effectively delaying PJM's RBP. In the filing, FERC accepts [PJM's RBP proposal](#) for filing but suspends it for five months (to Feb 28, 2027), flagging (1) cost allocation, (2) Transmission Owner exit rules, and (3) LSE collateral requirements as unjust/reasonable. We note that PJM can avoid an extended paper hearing if it addresses FERC's concerns and modifies its proposal accordingly within 30 days. While the filing comes largely unexpected, we continue to believe IPPs stand well positioned to benefit from higher power prices or PPA signings over time. Twelve PJM utilities [filed](#) their data center load forecasts yesterday, which, at a high level, suggested a cut to 2027 and uptick in 2029-2031. Thursday and Friday PJM cash prices clearing over >\$200 highlight significantly near-term volatility within the system. For TLN, we view yesterday's [announcement](#) as a positive, with Terry Nutt well respected and the accelerated share repurchase program demonstrating notable confidence in the LT outlook.
- **IPPs (0.9%) outperformed both Utilities (-0.1%) and the broader market (-0.5%) over the past week.**

Figure 1: Weekly Dashboard

Total Return	1Wk	YTD	2026 ATC Forwards	1Wk	Price	2027 ATC Forwards	1Wk	Price
CEG	0.3%	-24.8%	PJM West	5.0%	\$72.40	PJM West	3.4%	\$74.81
NRG	-3.5%	-38.4%	PJM East	5.0%	\$72.26	PJM East	3.4%	\$75.72
TLN	4.8%	-16.0%	PJM Ni Hub	6.2%	\$41.56	PJM NiHub	3.3%	\$43.67
VST	2.1%	-12.3%	ISO NE (MA)	3.0%	\$33.43	ISO NE (MA)	-1.0%	\$40.28
IPPs	0.9%	-22.9%	ERCOT North	3.3%	\$33.12	ERCOT North	-0.4%	\$39.04
S&P Utilities	-0.1%	-5.0%	ERCOT West	-5.2%	\$69.16	ERCOT West	-2.8%	\$78.72
S&P 500	-0.5%	13.0%	Spot Commodity	1Wk	Price	Spot Commodity	1Wk	Price
AMNA	-3.1%	20.6%	Henry Hub Gas	9.3%	\$3.18	Tetco M3	8.9%	\$1.48

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.; Forward pricing as of 9/29/2026.

- **News flow.** On Tuesday, TLN [announced](#) a planned CEO succession, confirming that company President Terry Nutt will serve as CEO beginning January 1, 2027, replacing Mac McFarland. Incrementally, TLN also announced a \$1.5bn accelerated share repurchase transaction and an upsized \$3.0bn share repurchase program. Following Tuesday's announcement, shares were up slightly post-market (~1%). Shares subsequently traded off Wednesday along with the broader IPP peers, driven by FERC's filing on the RBP we believe. [OKLO fielded](#) a rejection from the FERC following its request to reinstate its Virginia project for consideration under the PJM interconnection study cycle. CEG [received](#) a Gateway for Accelerated Innovation in Nuclear (GAIN) voucher from the DOE, supporting research

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Key Reports:

Initiations: [CEG](#), [TLN](#), [VST](#), [IPPs Slides](#), [OKLO](#), [XE](#)

[JPM Fall Question Bank, 9/8](#)

[2026 Spring Series Slides, 6/2](#)

[Nuclear Sector Launch Slides, 5/28](#)

[NARUC 2026 Summer, 7/23](#)

[Nuclear Power & SMR Thoughts, 10/17](#)

Data Center: [McKinsey](#), [LineVision](#)

Power Trader: [I](#), [II](#), [III](#)

Nukes: [I](#), [II](#), [III](#), [IV](#), [V](#), [VI](#), [VII](#), [VIII](#), [IX](#), [X](#), [XI](#)

LDSE Series: [NREL](#), [I](#), [II](#), [III](#)

Excess Capacity:

[PJM](#), [ERCOT](#), [MISO](#), [SERC/FRCC](#)

[TerraPower Fireside Takeaways, 6/15](#)

[XE Initiation, 5/19](#)

[OKLO Initiation, 5/11](#)

See page 12 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

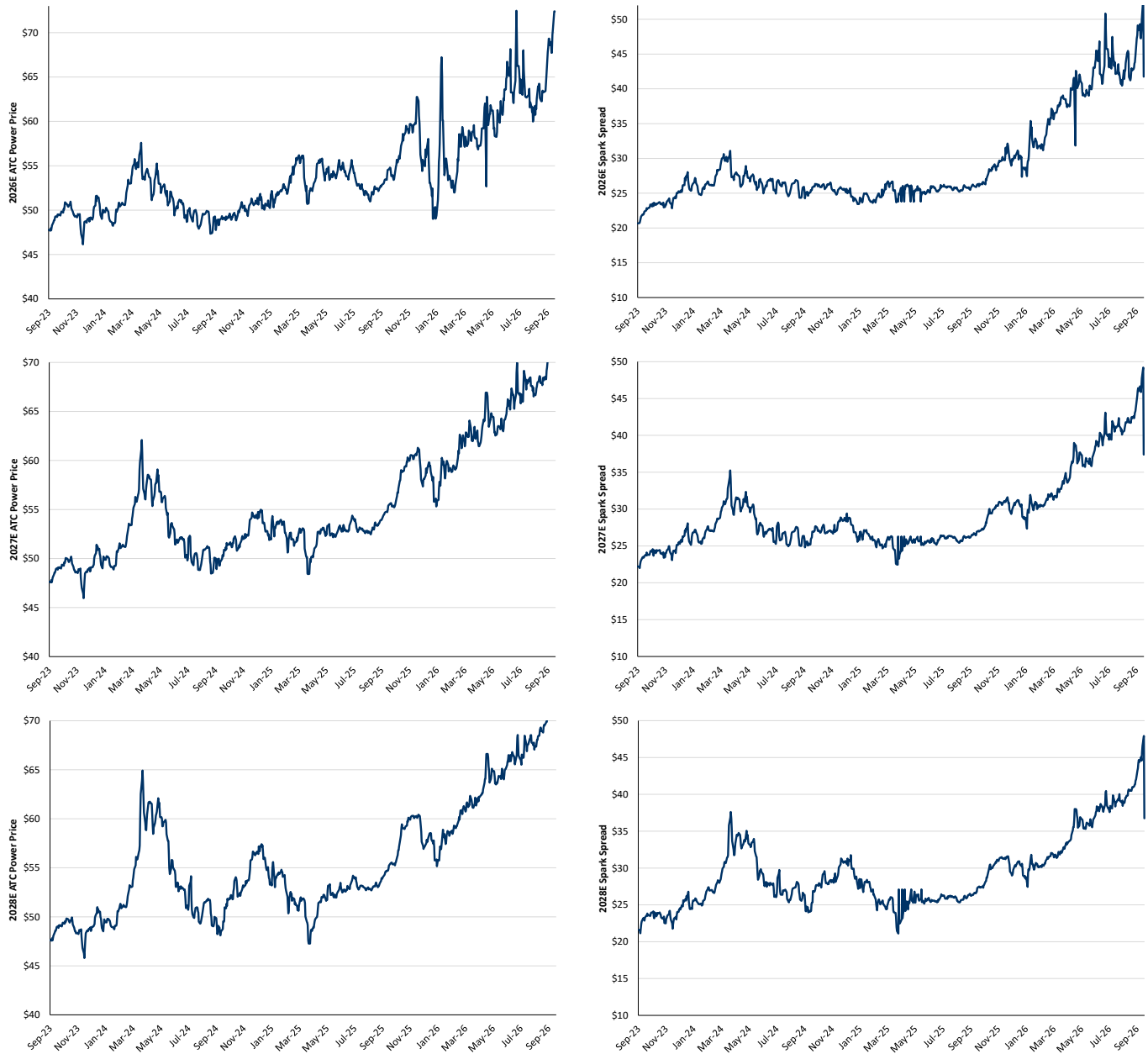
with ORNL to investigate the physics of boiling water nuclear reactors. **XE** [announced](#) the retirement of Joel Duling, President of TRISO-X. **The NRC** [approved](#) a construction permit for the Tennessee Valley Authority to build a small modular reactor, marking a first for SMR construction in the US. The TVA plans to build a 300MW GEV-Hitachi boiling-water reactor at its Clinch River site in Oak Ridge, TN. NRC completed its review and licensing decision in 14 months, ahead of schedule by ~4 months.

[Power FAQs and Supply/Demand Trends Thoughts, 12/16](#)

[Power Supply Demand Compilation, 10/17](#)
[Nuclear Compilation, 1/16](#)

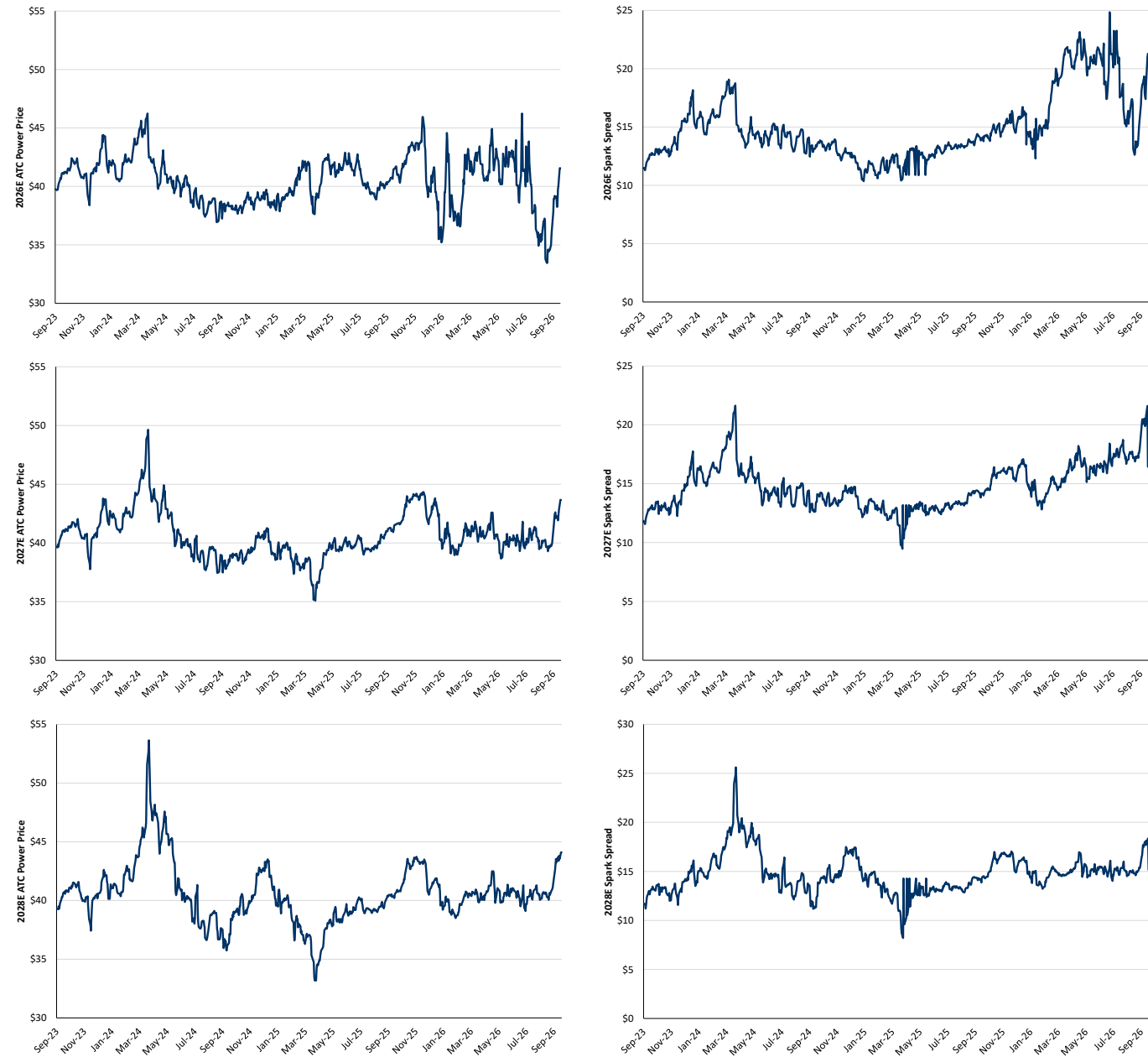
- **[Houston, We Have a \(Delay\)](#): data center regulations in Texas and implications for projects.** This week, our credit colleagues got an update on the Texas data center audits/restrictions directed by Governor Greg Abbott. Here they attempt to summarize the main regulatory hurdles posed by recent actions and weigh the actual risk this poses to Texas data center projects. As a spoiler, the team concludes that around half of the projects are already partially online and generating revenue, limiting the impact of the audit/permitting changes, and the other half could face delays potentially extending past election season, but tenants will be incentivized to work with builders as this is a systemic issue beyond Texas.
- **[BE](#): takeaways from meeting with management.** Our Clean Energy team hosted Bloom Energy's management team in NY. They viewed overall tone as very positive despite recent macro and policy headwinds facing some data center buildout, with management highlighting the various ways the company wins across total cost of ownership, time to power, load following ability, community acceptability, and platform optionality. The team also notes recently positive news on the company's possible manufacturing expansion and a major utility's IRP filing as positive indicators of demand. Below are their key takeaways. They rate BE Overweight.
- **[LBRT](#): inside the corner suite: 10 key takeaways from JPM's U.S. All Stars conference and CEO roadshow to Europe.** Our OFS team hosted CEO Ron Gusek and Anjali Voria, VP of IR, at JPM's 16th annual U.S. All Stars conference in London and a non-deal roadshow through Europe. It was good timing as the investor meetings with LBRT took place just after they published JPM's Behind-the-Meter (BTM) deep dive series ([see link](#)). LBRT's roadshow reinforced a bullish long-term demand backdrop for BTM power tied to data center load growth, with management commentary broadly corroborating their analysis that points to a structural power deficit into 2030 (we see a 50 to 80 GW supply gap). Specific to LBRT, the company is focused on 8 core projects in its commercial pipeline, which encompass well north of 3 GW of generation demand. Encouragingly, these projects are spread across 5 states and multiple customers, providing geographic diversification, which we view as important given rising regulatory scrutiny of data center construction activities (NIMBY concerns). One of the investor concerns ahead of the roadshow was the more crowded playing field for providers of distributed power (AESI, KGS, PUMP, SEI, WMB), but another key learning was the fairly limited competitive pressures that LBRT was observing on its core projects, which they believe reflects the mismatch between demand and generation capacity as well as the company's differentiated BTM offering.
- **Commodity corner.** Over the past week, forward ATC prices have experienced an uptick across the board, except for ICO NE. On a YTD basis, PJM West and East 2027 ATC power prices have tracked ~\$12/MWh higher, while ERCOT North and West 2027 ATC prices have decreased ~\$7/MWh and ~\$9/MWh, respectively. 2028 forward ATC prices have also seen mixed action, trending ~\$15/MWh higher YTD in PJM and ~\$3-6/MWh lower across ERCOT.
- Please see our Utilities and IPPs Spring Series [slides](#) and [replay](#).
- Please see our Utilities and IPPs 2026 outlook [slides](#) and [replay](#).

PJM West Forward ATC Power Prices and Spark Spreads



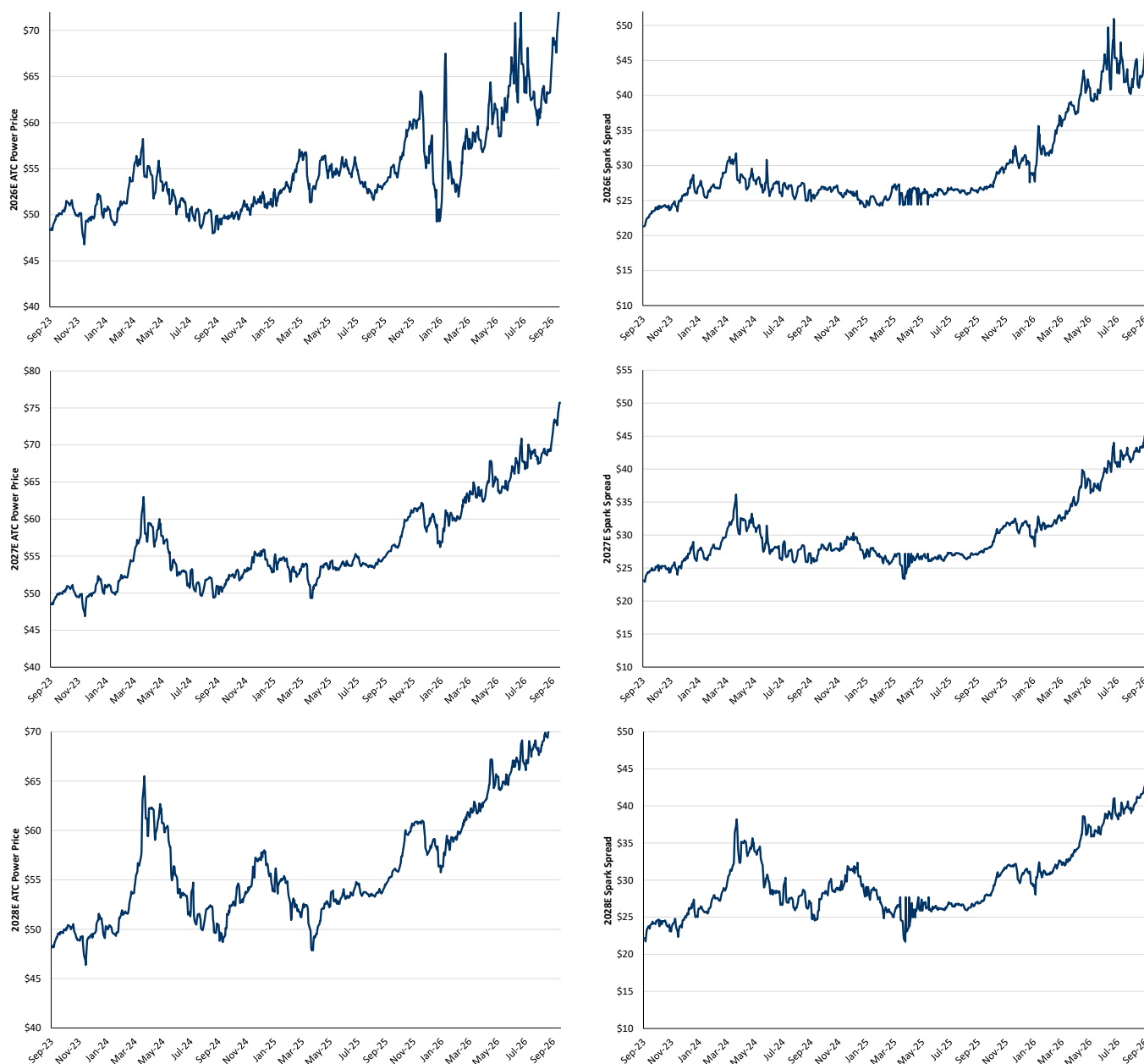
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. PJM West spark spread calculated by subtracting the product of the forward Tetco M3 gas price and 7,000 heat rate from the forward ATC power price.

PJM Ni Hub Forward ATC Power Prices and Spark Spreads



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. PJM Ni Hub spark spread calculated by subtracting the product of the forward Chicago Citygate gas price and 7,000 heat rate from the forward ATC power price.

PJM East Forward ATC Power Prices and Spark Spreads



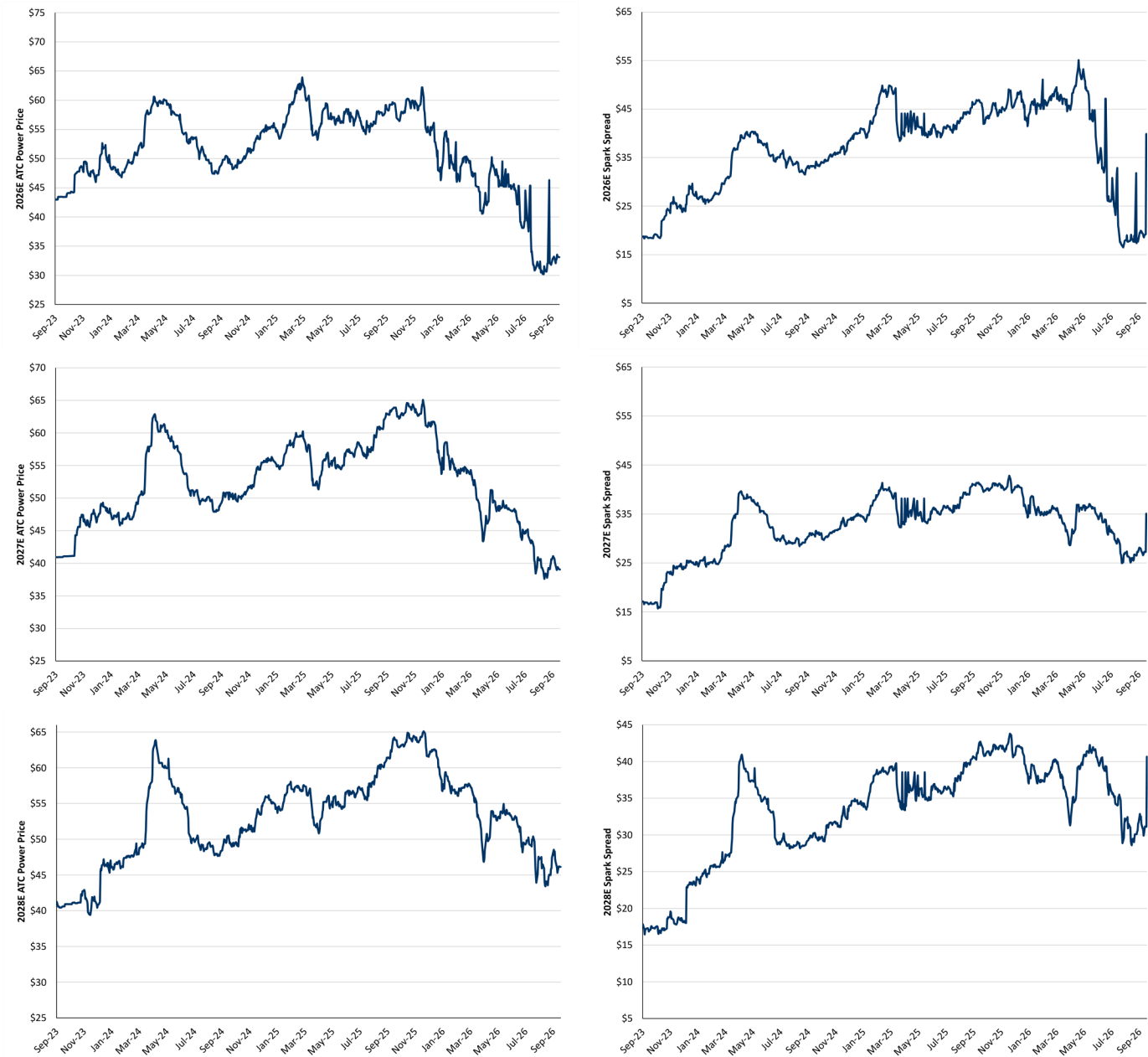
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. PJM East spark spread calculated by subtracting the product of the forward Tetco M3 gas price and 7,000 heat rate from the forward ATC power price.

ERCOT North Forward ATC Power Prices and Spark Spreads



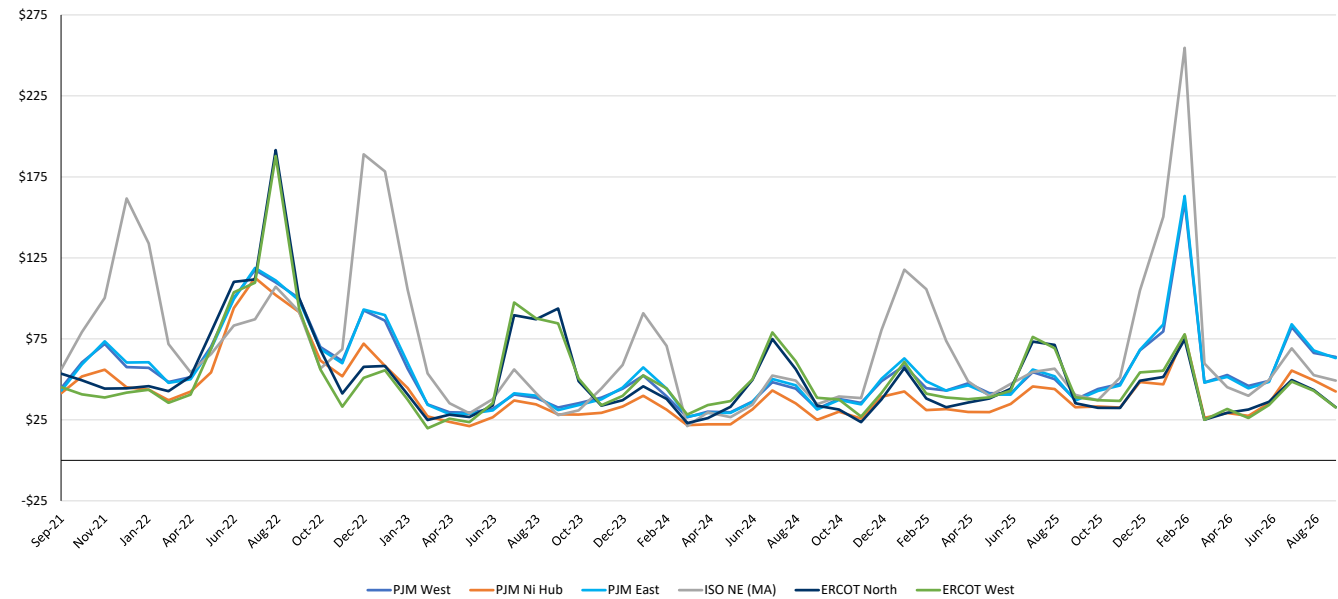
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. ERCOT North spark spread calculated by subtracting the product of the forward Houston Ship Channel gas price and 7,000 heat rate from the forward ATC power price.

ERCOT West Forward ATC Power Prices and Spark Spreads

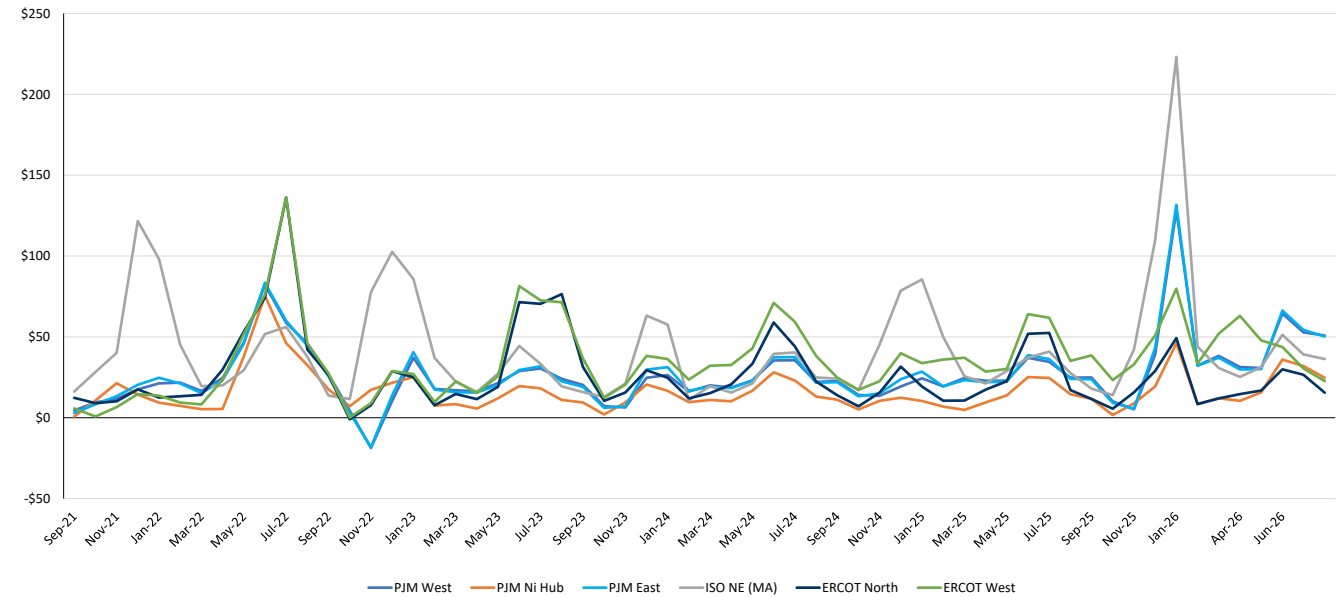


Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. ERCOT West spark spread calculated by subtracting the product of the forward Waha gas price and 7,000 heat rate from the forward ATC power price.

Historical ATC Power Prices



Historical Spark Spreads



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. All ATC and gas contracts priced monthly on the last date of the month (e.g., 3/31).

Valuation, Growth Outlook, and Insider Holdings

Figure 2: Valuation

										Forecasted										Cash Flow Yields (FCF + CFO-cases)													
Company	Ticker	Rating	Lead Analyst	Mkt Cap (\$ MM)	EV (\$ MM)	Price Target	Price	Current Yield	Total Return	P/E (Street median)			EV / EBITDA			Adj CFOMM Cap			FCF to Equity			FCF to EV			DCF								
										2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Constellation Energy	CEG	OW	Tonet	\$93,743	\$117,711	\$185	\$264.58	0.59%	46.2%	22.2x	20.5x	15.6x	13.0x	11.6x	9.4x	7.9%	9.2%	9.9%	0.4%	4.8%	6.9%	0.3%	4.0%	6.1%	4.8%	6.4%	8.0%						
NRG Energy	NRG	Not covered	N/A	\$20,426	\$46,342		\$97.17			10.7x	8.8x	7.6x	8.0x	7.3x	6.9x				10.2%	10.8%	10.8%	6.7%	7.4%	8.3%									
Talen Energy	TLN	OW	Tonet	\$19,085	\$26,449	\$440	\$114.84	0.00%	29.8%	17.3x	14.0x	11.7x	11.5x	8.4x	7.4x	8.7%	10.1%	14.2%	-10.0%	10.3%	10.3%	-9.6%	8.8%	7.9%	8.2%	11.6%	13.9%						
Visita Corp	VST	OW	Tonet	\$47,268	\$68,870	\$251	\$140.83	0.66%	64.7%	16.3x	15.6x	12.3x	10.1x	8.4x	7.2x	12.4%	13.8%	16.1%	-3.6%	9.6%	10.8%	-2.3%	5.7%	7.5%	9.2%	11.5%	13.7%						
Mean				\$44,139	\$64,343			0.41%	59.20%	16.6x	14.8x	11.8x	10.7x	9.0x	7.7x	10.0%	11.4%	13.4%	-8.7%	10.1%	12.1%	-1.2%	6.8%	7.8%	7.4%	9.7%	11.9%						
Median				\$33,647	\$57,606			0.59%	46.16%	16.8x	14.8x	12.0x	10.8x	8.4x	7.3x	9.7%	12.1%	14.2%	-1.9%	9.4%	11.4%		5.7%	7.7%	8.2%	11.4%	13.7%						

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. All NRG values sourced from Bloomberg median estimates. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Figure 3: Growth Outlook

Company	Ticker	Rating	Lead Analyst	Dividend Estimates						Growth	Current Yield Based on			Buyback Yield			Div + Buyback		
				Annual Dividend			Growth Rates			CAGR	Annual Dividend			Buyback Yield			Yield		
				2026E	2027E	2028E	'26/'25	'27/'26	'28/'27	27/24	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Constellation Energy	CEG	OW	Tonet	1.71	1.88	2.06	51.2%	10.0%	10.0%	83.0%	0.64%	0.71%	0.78%	0.00%	1.06%	1.06%	0.64%	1.77%	1.84%
NRG Energy	NRG	Not covered	N/A	1.93	2.07	2.24	9.5%	7.4%	7.9%	8.3%	0.7%	0.8%	0.8%						
Talen Energy	TLN	OW	Tonet	0.00	0.00	0.00					0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.66%	4.59%	9.19%	0.66%	4.59%	9.19%
Visita Corp	VST	OW	Tonet	0.93	0.97	1.01	13.3%	4.1%	4.3%	23.0%	0.35%	0.37%	0.38%	3.93%	1.26%	2.51%	4.28%	1.62%	2.90%
Mean							24.7%	7.2%	7.4%	38.1%	0.43%	0.46%	0.50%	1.53%	2.30%	4.25%	1.86%	2.66%	4.64%
Median							13.3%	7.4%	7.9%	23.0%	0.50%	0.54%	0.58%	0.66%	1.26%	2.51%	0.66%	1.77%	2.90%

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. All NRG values sourced from Bloomberg median estimates. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Figure 4: IPP Insider Holdings

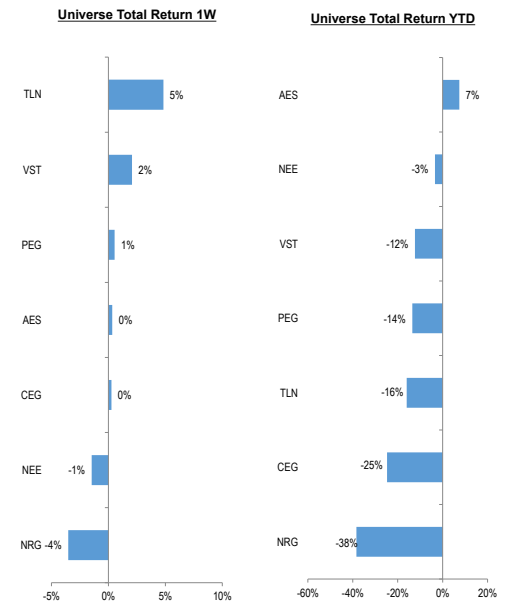
Ticker	% Held by Insiders	Change last 6M
CEG	0.2%	0.9%
NRG	0.6%	1.6%
TLN	1.5%	376.2%
VST	1.0%	-2.7%

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Total Return Performance, Relative Liquidity, Consensus EBITDA Estimate Revisions, and Sources of Return

Figure 5: Total Return Performance

Symbol		Unit Price	Rating	PT	YTD	1W	1M	3M	1Y
Relevant Indices									
UTY	UTY Index	\$1,013			-3.0%	-0.2%	-5.5%	-10.3%	-3.5%
S&P 500	SPX Index	\$7,671			13.0%	-0.5%	-0.1%	2.6%	16.0%
S&P Energy	S&ENRS Index	\$945			40.3%	-1.1%	-2.7%	17.3%	42.4%
US IPPs									
CEG	CEG US Equity	\$264.58	Overweight	\$385.00	-24.8%	0.3%	-3.7%	6.7%	-19.1%
NRG	NRG US Equity	\$97.17			-38.4%	-3.5%	-11.8%	-33.2%	-39.3%
TLN	TLN US Equity	\$314.84	Overweight	\$440.00	-16.0%	4.8%	6.5%	-18.1%	-26.0%
VST	VST US Equity	\$140.83	Overweight	\$231.00	-12.3%	2.1%	2.7%	-11.1%	-27.7%
US Diversified Utes									
AES	AES US Equity	\$14.86	N/A	N/A	7.4%	0.3%	0.8%	2.6%	18.6%
NEE	NEE US Equity	\$75.89	N/A	N/A	-3.4%	-1.5%	-7.8%	-12.9%	3.4%
PEG	PEG US Equity	\$67.68	Neutral	\$81.00	-13.5%	0.5%	-6.9%	-15.8%	-16.1%



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Figure 6: Trade Data & Relative Liquidity

Ticker	Price	Market Cap (\$ Bn)	Trade Data					Liquidity Data								
			52-Week High	52-Week Low	% of 52 Week High	% of 52 Week Low	Insider Ownership (%)	Shares Out. (mm)	Shares Float (mm)	% of Shares Floated	3 Month Avg Daily Volume (\$ mm)	3 Month Ave Price	3M Avg Daily Volume (shares, mm)	Short Int (shares, mm)	Short Int (\$ mm)	Days to Cover - 3M Avg
Independent Power Producers																
CEG	\$264.58	93.7	\$412.70	\$228.63	64%	116%	0.2%	354.3	328.5	93%	2,893,392	265.63	768.6	11.7	3,118.6	4.1
NRG	\$97.17	20.4	\$189.96	\$96.73	51%	100%	0.6%	210.2	208.9	99%	2,764,423	119.58	330.6	5.8	697.9	2.1
TLN	\$314.84	15.1	\$451.28	\$279.77	70%	113%	1.5%	47.9	47.2	99%	781,142	331.27	258.8	2.7	897.3	3.5
VST	\$140.83	47.3	\$217.10	\$132.66	65%	106%	1.0%	335.6	332.3	99%	4,391,899	146.71	644.4	2.7	397.4	0.6
US Diversified Utilities																
AES	\$14.86	10.6	\$17.65	\$12.97	84%	115%	0.6%	713.4	709.2	99%	7,821,473	14.76	115.5	18.5	272.8	2.4
NEE	\$29.99	5.3	\$42.23	\$22.88	71%	131%	2.7%	175.3	170.6	97%	1,794,485	33.80	60.6	7.6	257.4	4.2
PEG	\$67.68	33.7	\$87.63	\$66.15	77%	102%	0.2%	498.4	497.4	100%	3,021,653	74.75	225.9	10.7	803.2	3.6
Mean		32.3			69%	112%	1%	333.6	327.7	98%	3,352,638	140.9	343.5	8.5	920.7	2.9
Median		28.4			70%	113%	1%	335.6	328.5	99%	2,893,392	119.6	258.8	7.6	697.9	3.5

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Figure 7: Consensus EBITDA Estimate Revisions

Entity Name	Ticker	2026E	-1Mn	-6Mn	-1Yr	2027E	-1Mn	-6Mn	-1Yr	2028E	-1Mn	-6Mn	-1Yr	2029E	-1Mn	-6Mn	-1Yr
US Independent Power Producers																	
Constellation Energy	CEG	\$1,843	1.2%	-1.4%	7.2%	\$8,334	-2.2%	N/A	13.8%	\$8,619	-3.5%	-5.9%	7.7%	\$10,258	-0.9%	-4.4%	16.3%
NRG Energy	NRG	\$1,218	-2.8%	-0.8%	-3.2%	\$5,514	0.0%	0.6%	7.7%	\$6,039	0.0%	0.8%	9.8%	\$6,426	0.1%	2.2%	11.4%
Talen Energy	TLN	\$336	-5.9%	4.0%	-17.6%	\$2,139	0.0%	2.4%	7.1%	\$2,716	-0.1%	8.2%	22.8%	\$2,985	0.5%	9.8%	28.9%
Vistra Corp	VST	\$1,655	-5.5%	-9.4%	-3.1%	\$7,293	0.0%	-0.7%	4.5%	\$8,076	0.1%	-4.4%	9.6%	\$8,793	0.4%	-4.7%	8.8%
US Diversified Utilities																	
AES Corp.	AES	\$666	-1.8%	-1.7%	-2.6%	\$3,085	4.2%	0.3%	-3.7%	\$3,336	4.8%	1.4%	-3.6%	\$3,530	4.4%	1.1%	-3.1%
NextEra Energy Inc.	NEE	\$4,903	1.3%	3.1%	10.3%	\$17,697	-4.0%	N/A	N/A	\$20,469	-4.3%	-0.1%	-3.0%	\$22,924	-4.0%	-1.7%	-1.1%
Public Service Enterprise Group	PEG	\$1,082	-4.5%	-4.1%	-12.3%	\$4,794	-0.7%	N/A	-6.6%	\$5,240	-0.3%	-3.0%	-2.9%	\$5,660	0.0%	-1.1%	1.6%

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

Figure 8: Sources of Return

		1-Yr Total Return	Consensus 2027E EPS Estimates			P/E Multiple (2027)			Consensus 2028E EPS Estimates			P/E Multiple (2028)			2025 Sources of Return				
Company	Ticker		Today	1 Year Ago	1-Yr Delta	Today	1 Year Ago	1-Yr Delta	Today	1 Year Ago	1-Yr Delta	Today	1 Year Ago	1-Yr Delta	2025 Total Return	FY+2 EPS Revision	Multiple Expansion	Dividend Yield	Other
IPPs																			
Constellation Energy	CEG	-19.1%	13.33	13.27	0.5%	19.85x	24.81x	-20.0%	16.61	16.81	-1.2%	15.9x	19.6x	-18.6%	58.8%	23.2%	18.2%	0.6%	16.8%
NRG Energy	NRG	-39.3%	11.08	10.37	6.8%	8.77x	15.62x	-43.8%	12.78	11.60	10.2%	7.6x	14.0x	-45.5%	78.9%	22.7%	40.0%	1.9%	14.3%
Talen Energy	TLN	-26.0%	29.55	24.51	20.6%	10.65x	17.35x	-38.6%	35.47	27.31	29.9%	8.9x	15.57x	-43.0%	86.1%	44.0%	22.7%	0.0%	19.4%
Vistra Corp	VST	-27.7%	10.17	10.08	1.0%	13.84x	19.44x	-28.8%	11.93	12.53	-4.8%	11.8x	15.63x	-24.5%	17.7%	2.6%	5.1%	0.6%	9.4%
Median		-26.8%						-33.70%						-33.8%	68.8%	22.9%	20.4%	0.6%	15.5%
US Diversified Utilities																			
AES Corp.	AES	18.6%	2.30	2.37	-3.0%	6.47x	5.56x	16.5%	2.44	2.26	8.0%	6.1x	5.8x	4.6%	18.2%	8.1%	1.6%	5.4%	3.1%
NextEra Energy Inc.	NEE	3.4%	4.40	4.32	1.8%	17.26x	17.47x	-1.3%	4.77	4.62	3.1%	15.9x	16.3x	-2.5%	15.5%	0.8%	11.2%	3.2%	0.3%
Public Service Enterprise Group	PEG	-16.1%	4.68	4.71	-0.8%	14.47x	17.70x	-18.3%	5.03	5.07	-0.8%	13.5x	16.5x	-18.2%	-1.9%	2.8%	-8.2%	3.0%	0.6%
Median		3.4%						-1.25%						-2.5%	15.5%	2.8%	1.6%	3.2%	0.6%

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Pricing as of 9/29/2026.

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Completed 30 Sep 2026 07:03 PM EDT

Disseminated 30 Sep 2026 07:06 PM EDT